

BRIAN ALEXANDER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Business and Legal Affairs counsel with 20+ years of hands-on experience in the acquisition, development, production, and licensing of nonfiction content, including documentary and unscripted series. Negotiates and drafts production, co-production, talent, rights, format, services, and distribution agreements; independently handles production legal, clearances, and practical issues from development through delivery. Experienced in-house partner to Content, Production, Finance, Marketing, Communications, and Legal teams, with a track record of working directly with producers, production companies, talent representatives, studios, networks, and streamers. California State Bar member.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Nonfiction & Documentary Series | Development, Production & Licensing Agreements | Production Services & Co-Production Agreements | Above-the-Line Talent & Producer Deals | Format Licenses & Options | Underlying Rights & Chain of Title | Releases, Clearances & Production Forms | Production Legal Counseling | Guild Compliance | Cross-Functional Partnership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SVP, Business & Legal Affairs | UMG / Polygram Entertainment

2017-2025

- Served as the lead in-house Business & Legal Affairs attorney for UMG's film and television slate, with primary responsibility for documentary and nonfiction projects; promoted from VP to SVP in 2019.
- Owned matters from acquisition and development through production, delivery, and distribution, working independently and directly with producers, production companies, talent representatives, studios, networks, streamers, estates, and rights holders.
- Negotiated and drafted development, production, co-production, financing, production services, rights acquisition, option, talent, licensing, and distribution agreements, as well as project-specific releases and clearance arrangements.
- Handled day-to-day production legal and clearance issues, including underlying rights, chain of title, music and archival materials, talent and participant matters, credits, approvals, exclusivity, guild issues, and delivery requirements.
- Partnered closely with Creative, Production, Finance, Marketing, Communications, and Legal to evaluate projects, review budgets, resolve issues quickly, and provide practical counsel throughout production.
- Structured and closed deals with Netflix, Amazon, Apple TV+, HBO, Disney, Sony, NBC, MGM, and other global partners, including multi-party projects requiring coordination of recorded music, publishing, footage, and talent rights.
- Designed greenlight and approval workflows and prepared deal approval memoranda for projects representing tens of millions of dollars in production commitments.

Selected nonfiction projects: *Selena y Los Dinos* (Netflix); *Noah Kahan: Out of Body* (Netflix); *The Bee Gees: How Can You Mend a Broken Heart* (HBO); *Beastie Boys Story* (Apple TV+); *Stax: Soulsville U.S.A.* (HBO); *Love to Love You, Donna Summer* (HBO); *Hitsville: The Making of Motown* (Showtime); *The Go-Go's* (Showtime); *Louis Armstrong's Black & Blues* (Apple TV+); *Paul McCartney: Man on the Run* (Amazon).

EARLIER NONFICTION EXPERIENCE

Director, Business & Legal Affairs | Discovery Communications (TLC) **2015-2017**

- Led Business & Legal Affairs for a high-volume slate of original unscripted, lifestyle, and family series, negotiating and drafting production, co-production, talent, participant, rights, and format agreements.
- Worked directly with productions and network teams to resolve clearance, production, exclusivity, digital, and delivery issues while maintaining deal momentum and consistent standards.
- Advised network leadership on franchise strategy, rights management, IP licensing, and brand extensions; developed forward-looking digital carve-outs for talent with social media influence.

Vice President, Business & Legal Affairs | Viacom (Paramount) **2011-2014**

- Negotiated and drafted agreements for original unscripted series, specials, and content acquisitions across Spike, VH1, and other Viacom networks, supporting projects from development through delivery.
- Handled above-the-line and below-the-line talent matters, production and rights agreements, guild compliance, and evolving multi-platform and SVOD rights structures.

Head of Production Legal | Magical Elves, Inc. **2009-2011**

- Built and led the production legal and Business Affairs function for a leading nonfiction production company during a period of rapid growth.
- Negotiated and drafted series, format, production, talent, contestant, participant, release, prize, clearance, branded entertainment, integration, trade-out, and sponsorship agreements for Top Chef and a broad unscripted slate.
- Advised producers and production teams daily on fast-moving legal and business issues, providing practical solutions that kept high-volume productions on schedule.

Director, Business & Legal Affairs | Discovery Communications **2005-2008**

- Negotiated talent, production, and rights agreements across a broad unscripted slate and advised on guild, clearance, production, and risk-management matters.

COMMUNITY & BOARD SERVICE

Court Appointed Special Advocate (CASA) - Volunteer advocate for youth in the Los Angeles County foster care and juvenile court systems.

Outfest - Former board member supporting LGBTQ+ filmmakers and independent storytelling.

EDUCATION & BAR ADMISSION

Juris Doctor (J.D.), with Honors - Florida State University College of Law; Editor, Journal of Land Use and Environmental Law

B.A., English Literature - Florida State University

California State Bar - Active Member